User Journey Document 01

Search → Card-Based Selection → Itinerary Creation

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1. Purpose of this document

This document defines the primary and most important user journey in the travel planning app.

It describes how a customer:

- lands on the app,
- searches for a city,
- explores cards for places and activities in that city,
- likes, rejects, or super-selects them,
- uses undo where needed,
- reviews selected places,
- generates an itinerary,
- adds trip details like dates and number of people,
- and saves the itinerary.

This is the core journey that establishes the product's value.

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2. Journey name

Journey 1: Search to Card-Based Selection to Itinerary Creation

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3. Journey summary

The customer opens the app and is immediately guided toward destination discovery through a search-first interface. They search for a city or choose from recommended cities. Once a city is selected, they enter a swipe-based, card-led exploration flow where they review places, attractions, restaurants, and activities.

Each card helps the user quickly decide whether they want to include the place in their trip. They can:

- swipe right to like,
- swipe left to discard,
- use a super-like action for strong preference,
- tap to view more detail,
- and undo the previous action if they made a mistake.

As they continue, the system builds a preference-backed list of selected items. When the user is ready, they move to a review screen where their chosen places are summarized. From there, they generate a day-by-day itinerary. The system organizes places based on logic like proximity, visit duration, and meal pairing. The user can then refine the itinerary by adding details such as dates, number of people, pace, and other trip-related information, and finally save the itinerary.

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4. Why this journey matters

This is the product's primary activation journey.

It is where the user first experiences the app's core promise:

turning destination exploration into a fast, visual, intuitive trip-planning workflow.

If this journey works well, the user should feel:

- inspired,
- in control,
- quickly productive,
- and confident that the app understands their travel preferences.

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5. User goal

The user wants to answer a simple question:

"What should I do in this city, and can you turn my preferences into a usable itinerary?"

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6. Product goal

The system should:

- reduce the complexity of browsing large destination catalogs,
- capture user preferences quickly,
- convert discovery into structured selections,
- and turn those selections into a useful itinerary draft.

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7. Start state and end state

Start state

The user opens the app and has not yet selected a city.

End state

The user has:

- chosen a city,
- reviewed place cards,
- created a set of selected places,
- generated a day-by-day itinerary,
- optionally added trip details,
- and saved the itinerary.

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8. User persona for this journey

This journey is designed for users who:

- know the city they want to visit, but not exactly what they want to do there
- want a more visual and enjoyable planning process
- do not want to browse long list views or travel blogs manually
- want quick decisions and smart itinerary generation

This can support:

- solo travelers
- couples
- families
- friend groups
- new travelers who want guided planning

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9. High-level journey flow

App Open
→ **Search Screen**
→ **City Search / Select City**
→ **Card-Based Discovery**
→ **Swipe / Like / Reject / Super-Like / Undo**
→ **Selection Summary**
→ **Generate Itinerary**
→ **Add Trip Details**
→ **Day-by-Day Itinerary Output**
→ **Save Itinerary**

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10. Detailed user journey flow

Step 1: Customer lands on the app

User intent

The customer wants to begin planning a trip.

User sees

The home screen opens with a clean, destination-first design. The primary focus is a city search bar at the top. Below it are recommended cities and possibly recent searches.

Primary UI elements

- top search bar
- recommended city cards
- recent search list

- optional inspirational travel banner
- bottom navigation

User actions

- type a city name
- tap a recommended city
- tap a recent search

System response

The app should immediately make it obvious that the journey begins with city selection.

Exit condition

The user selects a city.

Step 2: Customer searches for a city

User intent

The customer knows the destination and wants to explore it.

User sees

As they type, they see:

- autocomplete city suggestions
- maybe country/region names
- recommended and recent cities still partially visible

User actions

- type destination name
- select a suggestion
- clear or change the query

System response

Once a city is selected, the app loads the discovery deck for that city.

Exit condition

City is confirmed and card discovery begins.

Step 3: Customer enters card-based city exploration

User intent

The customer wants to quickly review interesting places in the city.

User sees

A stack of large cards, one in focus, representing places or activities in the chosen city.

Each card contains:

- place name
- place type/category
- image carousel or 4–5 photos
- short description
- tags
- rating or popularity cue
- estimated time needed
- area or neighborhood
- optional price guidance

A filter area appears at the top.

Action buttons appear at the bottom.

User actions

- swipe right to like
- swipe left to discard
- tap super-like for strong preference
- tap the card to open detailed view
- tap left/right on image zones to cycle photos
- apply filters
- use undo after a recent action

System response

The app records the action and immediately advances to the next card.

Important rule

After the first swipe or action, the interface should make **Undo** clearly available.

Exit condition

The user continues until they have enough selected places or intentionally moves to summary.

Step 4: Customer reviews a card in detail

User intent

The customer wants more confidence before choosing.

User sees

When they tap a card, they open a detail view with fuller information.

This includes:

- larger image gallery
- detailed description
- richer tags
- timing/open hours
- approximate cost
- expected duration
- map/location snippet
- short review summary
- why it may fit the trip

User actions

- scroll vertically
- like
- reject
- super-like
- close and go back

System response

The decision can be taken directly from the detail view without extra friction.

Exit condition

The user either acts on the place or returns to the card stack.

Step 5: Customer builds preferences over time

User intent

The customer wants to curate a personalized set of places.

What happens

Over multiple cards, the system builds four preference groups:

- liked
- super-liked
- discarded
- unreviewed

Experience goal

This should feel:

- fast
- visual
- fun
- lightweight
- not overwhelming

System learning

The app may quietly infer interests such as:

- food-heavy
- cultural
- luxury
- family-friendly
- nightlife
- hidden gems
- fast-paced
- relaxed sightseeing

Exit condition

The user is ready to review their picks.

Step 6: Customer reviews selections

User intent

The customer wants to see what has been chosen before creating the itinerary.

User sees

A structured summary of selected places.

The summary screen should clearly separate:

- super-liked places
- liked places
- optionally discarded places in a secondary tab

Each item should show:

- thumbnail
- place name
- category
- area
- key tags
- remove action

User actions

- remove items
- go back to continue swiping
- proceed to itinerary generation

System response

The app prepares the selection set for itinerary creation.

Exit condition

The user taps the button to generate an itinerary.

Step 7: Customer generates itinerary

User intent

The customer wants the app to turn preferences into a usable plan.

User sees

A short setup screen before generation. This should not be long or form-heavy.

Input fields

- itinerary name
- number of days
- dates if known
- number of travelers
- pace: relaxed / balanced / packed
- budget preference
- food inclusion preference
- start/end area or stay location if known

User actions

- provide details
- skip optional details
- tap generate

System response

The system creates a day-by-day itinerary by organizing selected places using planning logic such as:

- grouping nearby places together
- balancing sightseeing with food stops
- avoiding excessive travel time
- distributing selections across days
- prioritizing super-liked places

Exit condition

Generated itinerary is shown.

Step 8: Customer sees day-by-day itinerary

User intent

The customer wants a usable trip plan.

User sees

A structured itinerary divided by day.

Each day should show:

- day title
- list/timeline of activities
- place cards or itinerary blocks
- meal suggestions where relevant
- approximate sequence
- quick indication of intensity or travel time

User actions

- rename itinerary
- edit number of days
- remove items
- add more places
- regenerate or optimize
- adjust dates
- adjust traveler count
- save details

System response

The app updates the itinerary structure accordingly.

Exit condition

The user is satisfied enough to save.

Step 9: Customer saves itinerary

User intent

The customer wants to preserve the trip.

User sees

A save action and confirmation state.

Details that may be saved

- itinerary name
- selected city
- selected places
- dates
- number of people
- pace
- saved structure by day

User actions

- save itinerary
- continue editing
- return later

System response

The itinerary is stored and made available for future access.

End condition

The journey is complete.

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11. Functional requirements

11.1 Search requirements

The app must:

- allow city search by name
- show autocomplete suggestions

- allow selection from recommended cities
- support recent searches
- transition smoothly into card discovery

11.2 Card deck requirements

The app must:

- show one main place card at a time
- support 4–5 images per card
- support tap-based image navigation
- support swipe left, swipe right, and super-like
- support tap to expand details
- support filter application
- support undo after recent actions

11.3 Detail view requirements

The app must:

- open an expanded detailed view for each place
- allow the user to read more before deciding
- allow action directly from the detailed view

11.4 Selection summary requirements

The app must:

- summarize liked and super-liked selections
- allow removals before itinerary generation
- support continuation back into card discovery

11.5 Itinerary generation requirements

The app must:

- generate a day-by-day itinerary from selected places
- use proximity and trip logic
- incorporate optional user inputs like dates and number of people
- allow edits before save

11.6 Save requirements

The app must:

- save the itinerary structure and trip details
- support return and re-edit later

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12. UX principles for this journey

This journey should feel:

Visual

The interface should be image-led and attractive. The user should feel inspired by destinations and places.

Fast

A decision should take seconds, not minutes.

Low-friction

The user should not be forced into long forms before seeing value.

Reversible

Undo should reduce anxiety and make swiping feel safe.

Progressive

The app should reveal complexity gradually:

- search first
- then discovery
- then summary
- then itinerary
- then optional details

Assistive

The itinerary should feel intelligently generated, not randomly assembled.

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13. Screen-by-screen UI specification

Screen 1: Search Landing Screen

Purpose

To start the trip planning journey with destination search.

Primary UI blocks

- app header
- large search bar
- recommended cities section
- recent searches
- bottom tab navigation

Required actions

- tap search
- type city
- select recommended city
- select recent city

Design direction

This screen should feel simple, premium, and immediately useful.

Screen 2: City Search / Autocomplete

Purpose

To help the customer choose the destination quickly.

UI blocks

- active search field
- autocomplete city suggestions
- clear/cancel actions
- recent searches below

Suggestion row content

- city name
- country or region
- small thumbnail or icon

Required actions

- select result
- modify query
- cancel

Screen 3: Card Discovery Deck

Purpose

To let the user explore places through swiping.

UI blocks

- back button
- city title
- filters row
- main place card stack
- action bar
- progress cue
- undo

Card content

- hero image
- image index indicators
- place name
- category
- tags
- short description
- neighborhood/area

- price level
- visit duration
- quality or popularity indicator

Action controls

- discard
- super-like
- like
- undo
- review selections

Key interaction rules

- swipe left = discard
- swipe right = like
- super-like button = strong preference
- undo appears after first actionable event
- tap card = detail view
- tap image edge = browse images

Screen 4: Filter Bottom Sheet

Purpose

To refine results without leaving the deck.

Suggested filters

- attractions
- restaurants
- shopping
- hidden gems
- culture
- nightlife
- budget
- time needed
- family-friendly

Actions

- apply

- clear all
- close

Screen 5: Place Detail Screen

Purpose

To provide deeper context before selection.

UI blocks

- image gallery
- title and category
- detailed description
- tags
- ratings/reviews
- duration
- timings
- location snippet
- recommendation cues
- fixed bottom action bar

Bottom actions

- discard
- super-like
- like

Screen 6: Selection Summary Screen

Purpose

To summarize chosen places before itinerary generation.

UI blocks

- header with count of selected places
- section for super-liked
- section for liked

- item list cards
- remove action
- continue swiping button
- generate itinerary button

Item card content

- thumbnail
- place name
- category
- area
- tags
- remove action

Screen 7: Itinerary Setup Screen

Purpose

To collect lightweight trip details before itinerary generation.

UI fields

- itinerary name
- dates
- number of days
- number of people
- pace
- budget
- food preference
- hotel or stay area if known

Actions

- skip some optional details
- generate itinerary

UX rule

Keep this compact. It should feel like setup, not form filling.

Screen 8: Generated Itinerary Screen

Purpose

To show the system-generated trip in a useful format.

UI blocks

- itinerary title
- trip summary
- day tabs or stacked days
- timeline/list of places per day
- edit controls
- add more
- optimize
- save

Each itinerary item should show

- time slot or rough order
- place name
- type
- estimated duration
- travel or transition hint
- meal stop indicator if relevant

Screen 9: Save Confirmation Screen

Purpose

To confirm that the itinerary and details have been saved.

UI blocks

- success confirmation
- itinerary preview
- saved details summary
- return/open trip CTA

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14. Edge cases and states

No city results

Show a fallback search state with nearby alternatives or spelling suggestions.

No cards after filters

Show an empty filter result state with “Clear filters”.

Accidental swipe

Undo must be easily accessible after the most recent action.

Too few selections

The app may suggest that the user keep exploring before generating an itinerary.

Too many places for number of days

The itinerary generator should warn the user that the schedule may be tight.

Missing dates

Dates should be optional unless needed later.

User leaves mid-flow

Progress in the city deck and selections should remain recoverable.

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15. What the customer should feel during this journey

The customer should feel:

- “This app understands how I want to plan”
- “I can make decisions quickly”
- “I am discovering useful places, not browsing noise”
- “The itinerary feels tailored to what I liked”
- “I can always correct a mistake”

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16. Acceptance criteria

This journey is successful if the user can:

1. open the app and search/select a city
2. browse city-specific cards
3. like, discard, super-like, and undo
4. review selected places
5. generate a day-by-day itinerary
6. add dates, number of people, and related trip details
7. save the itinerary

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17. Handoff prompt for Figma Make / Replit / AI design tools

Use this prompt to generate the first detailed version of the app flow:

> Design a premium mobile-first travel planning app focused on a core journey where the user searches for a city and then discovers places through a swipe-based card deck. The home screen should have a large city search bar, recommended city cards, and recent searches. After selecting a city, the user enters a Tinder-like discovery deck of place cards with 4–5 images, place name, category, tags, short description, area, duration, and price cue. The user can swipe left to discard, swipe right to like, tap a center super-like button for strong preference, tap card images to browse, tap the card to view more detail, and use an undo action after recent swipes. The flow should include a selection summary screen that separates super-liked and liked places, followed by an itinerary setup screen where the user can add itinerary name, dates, number of days, number of people, pace, budget, and food preferences. The system then shows a day-by-day generated itinerary with editable blocks, meal pairing logic, add-more controls, and a save action. The

visual style should feel professional, polished, modern, travel-focused, image-led, and suitable for a high-quality consumer mobile app.